



Plants for urban gardens

Urban gardens are generally warmer than their surrounding areas and provide suitable growing conditions for a wide range of plants.

Even though most urban gardens are small, they can be made to look larger by disguising their boundaries with leafy trees and shrubs, such as ninebark, magnolia, and viburnum. Always remember that the soil next to walls and fences will be sheltered from the rain and therefore dry, so plant at least 12in (30cm) away from vertical surfaces where roots will find more moisture. You can create year-round color with evergreens and add a selection of deciduous plants for their seasonal flowers, fruit, and fall foliage.



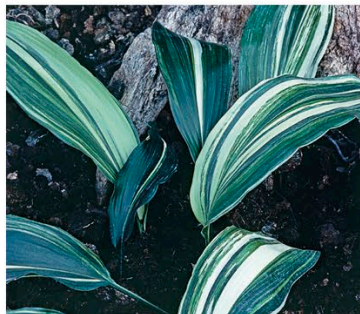
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aquilegia vulgaris Vervaeana Group

WOODSIDE SERIES COLUMBINE This upright perennial has rounded, divided, orange- and gold-splashed olive-green leaves. In spring, two-tone flowers in white, red, pink, or blue appear. Deadhead to prevent self-seeding.

↑3ft (1m) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aspidistra elatior

CAST-IRON PLANT An evergreen perennial with upright, narrow, glossy dark green leaves. Cream to purple summer flowers may appear near soil level. 'Variegata' (above) has cream-striped leaves. Ideal for summer borders or pots in deep shade.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z7–10



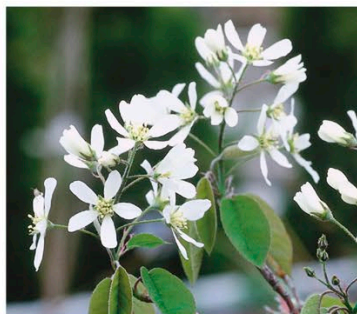
PERENNIAL SMALL

Brunnera macrophylla

SIBERIAN BUGLOSS This ground-cover perennial has large heart-shaped leaves that form a low carpet and delicate sprays of small bright blue spring flowers. Shelter it from drying winds. 'Dawson's White' (above) has cream-variegated foliage.

↑18in (45cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z3–8



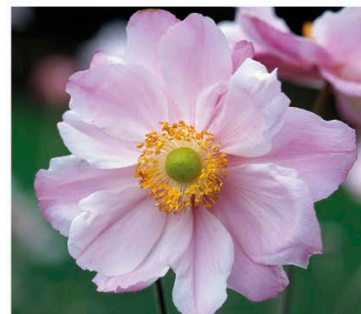
TREE SMALL

Amelanchier canadensis

SHADBLOW SERVICEBERRY An upright, dense deciduous shrub with oval white-haired leaves that age to dark green and turn orange-red in fall. It bears starry white flowers from mid- to late spring and edible maroon, sweet and juicy fruits in summer.

↑20ft (6m) ↔10ft (3m)

☀ pH Z3–7 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Anemone x hybrida

JAPANESE ANEMONE This is an upright perennial with divided, dark green basal leaves. From late summer to early fall, it produces large, pink or white single or double flowers. 'Queen Charlotte' (above) is a popular pink double variety.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔indefinite

☀ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astrantia major

MASTERWORT A clump-forming perennial with divided midgreen leaves. From midsummer to early fall, it produces sprays of small green and white, pink or red flowers. 'Hadspen Blood' (above) produces dark red flowers.

↑3ft (1m) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z4–7



SHRUB MEDIUM

Aucuba japonica

JAPANESE LAUREL This bushy evergreen shrub has glossy dark green leaves. Small purplish flowers in mid-spring are followed by red berries on female plants. 'Crotonifolia' (above) has yellow-spotted foliage. Trim it annually in spring.

↑↔6ft (2m)

☀ ! Z7–10



SHRUB LARGE

Buxus sempervirens

COMMON BOXWOOD This evergreen shrub has oval, glossy dark green leaves. It tolerates close clipping and makes a dense low hedge or screen in a city garden. Disinfect pruning tools regularly to prevent the spread of fungal diseases.

↑↔15ft (5m)

☀ Z6–8



SHRUB LARGE

Camellia japonica

JAPANESE CAMELLIA A bushy evergreen shrub with glossy, ovate, leathery dark green leaves. Plants are covered with single or double, white to deep pink flowers for a month or longer in spring. It tolerates full shade.

↑10ft (3m) ↔6ft (2m)

☀ pH Z7–9